

The New Testament

The imagery of the New Testament is familiar to most of us from Christmas cards and carols and from the Christian symbol of the cross. But the stories themselves are memorable too.

An ordinary Jewish couple suddenly find their lives turned upside down by an angel, who explains that their child will be the son of God.

As a baby, Jesus is visited



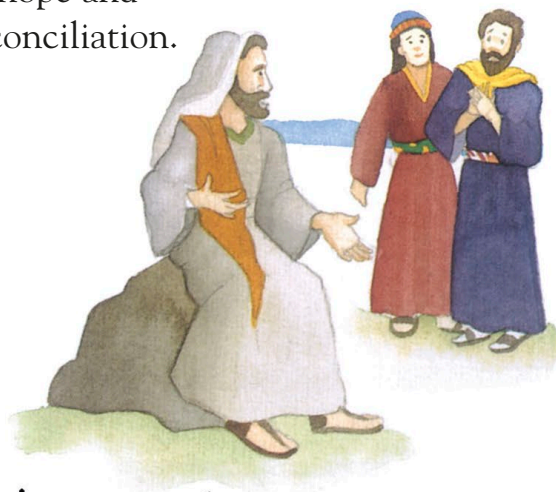
by important men with rich gifts and a powerful king wants to kill him. As a boy, he amazes people with his wisdom and learning. And as a man, Jesus is a great teacher and performs astonishing miracles, like feeding five thousand people with just five loaves of bread and two fishes.

The New Testament moves from the promise of the first Christmas to

its fulfillment in the pain and hope of the Crucifixion and Resurrection. The Easter story is not an easy one for young children, but we owe them the truth about what happened to the man who preached love, peace, and forgiveness. The sorrow of Jesus' death on Good Friday is followed quickly by the joy of his rising from the dead on the first Easter Sunday and this is at the heart of Christian belief.

The Bible begins with Creation and this Bible story collection ends with the Resurrection, both powerful images of fresh starts.

In writing **A First Bible Story Book** I have tried to convey some of the excitement and power of the well-known stories within a framework of hope and reconciliation.



Mary McHoffman

